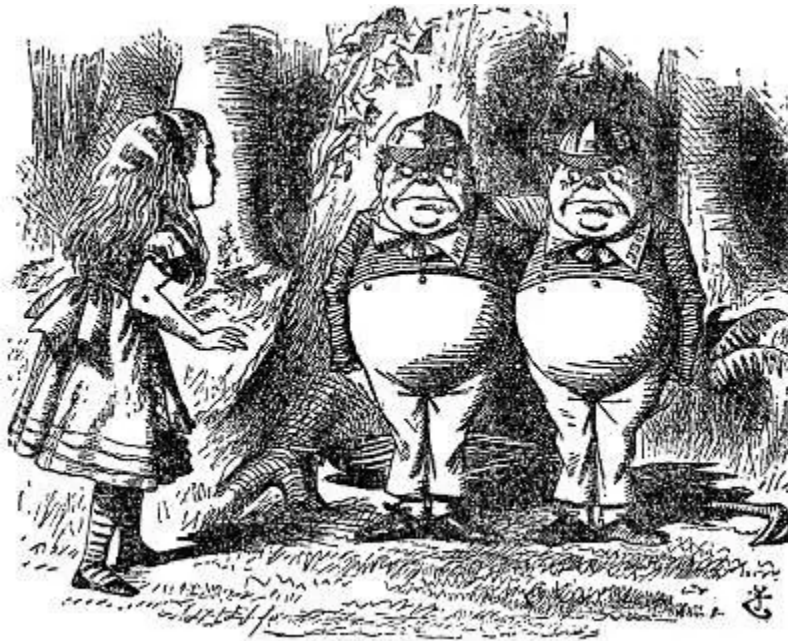


Front Page

Logistics of a More Efficient Democracy

- *By Alistair Norfleet*



I know what you're thinking about," said Tweedle-dum, "But it ain't so, nohow."
"Contrariwise," continued Tweedledee, "if it was so, it might be; and if it were so, it would be;
but as it isn't, it ain't. That's logic.

-Lewis Carroll

Background Research

Background Research

PLAN→B 2030



 **Children's
Parliament**

Neue 
Generation

Plan B 2030

Plan B 2030¹



PLAN→B 2030

About Plan B -

- Initiative that believes in connecting communities and “climate first” engineering
 - Focused on individual benefits of “group identity”
- Multiple projects in progress -
 - Actively update as each project develops
 - IMPORTANT: (It must still be within their purview)
- Moves labor from government to NGO to citizens -
 - Marketed as “communication opportunity” rather than “undesirable, thankless, and often frustrating work”

Mission Statement PB

Mission Statement:

- Their goal is *directly* tied to two already existing platforms –
 - *Our goal is a climate-neutral and socially just Berlin that conforms to the model of a doughnut economy and implements the Paris Agreement and the Sustainable Development Goals in Berlin.*
 - This foundationally links their organization with all aspects of both agreements
 - Including but not limited to:
 - Politicians who support it
 - Parties who support it
 - Initiatives that support it
 - People who individuals know that support it
 - etc...
 - Not only that –
 - But their social aspect directly ties to our existing understanding of *engagement* →

A reminder: No democracy is complete without a side of **FRIES**

1. **Fair Processes**

- a. As the mechanics of democracy, fair processes respect the principle of “one person, one vote” and hold policy-making institutions accountable through checks and balances.

2. **Responsive Policy**

- a. As an output of democracy, responsive policy weighs all citizens’ interests and values equally, provides for the common good, and establishes institutions that empower individuals to protect their rights.

3. **Information & Communication**

- a. These elements mediate the relationship between citizens, processes, and policy. Information and communication that are representative, accurate, and trusted ensure fair processes and enable citizens to hold policymakers accountable.

4. **Empowered Citizens**

- a. The people are the principal actors in a democracy. Citizens are empowered when their rights are protected, they are informed, and fellow citizens and policymakers proactively engage them in the democratic process.

5. **Social Cohesion**

- a. A shared sense of purpose and identity is implicit in the enduring phrase “we the people.” A democratic society’s members recognize each other’s right to a voice in the political process and are willing to collaborate for common ends.

Engagement/Democracy

Engagement

- Their idea of 'Mission-Oriented' engagement directly ties to our preliminary definition of it

- *FRIES*

- Moves the labor from NGOs back to the community, directly affecting lives of locals by empowering their access to safe communication

- *Solar*

- Places importance of engagement on the *action* not the mentality

- *Local engagement*

- Starts at the house-level - directly dealing with *non-problematic* issues
 - Shows individuals that the model works
 - Scales at its own pace

Democracy

- Their idea of democracy is highly tied to an understanding of “opportunity cost”
- With any opportunity, there is a *cost* of pursuing it –
 - Usually that takes the form of
 - Money
 - Time
 - Effort
- Often, organizations that fall apart stretch themselves too thin – and lose resources too quickly to keep the lasting changes they want to see in democracy²
 - By moving labor to the community, we both *empower citizens* AND reduce *overhead fees*
 - Fun fact: the largest cost **on aggregate** for NGOs is Personnel

² Fiete has mentioned this concept in regards to “how do we finance that connection with government and labor”

Projects/Success

Projects

- Solar Power to the People



Solar Power to the People

**Your balcony.
Your energy.**

With solar power from your balcony, you can reduce your electricity costs by up to 25% and make the climate transition visible – even as a tenant. Together, we apply for, purchase, and install balcony power plants throughout Berlin.

[Start now](#)

- TogetherNeighborhood

TogetherNeighborhood

**Your neighborhood.
Your actions.**

Your house, your street, your neighborhood: We support you and your neighbors in making your environment safe, socially responsible, and climate-neutral – and in making Berlin a livable place for you.

[Join now](#)



- Implementation Alliance Berlin



Implementation Alliance Berlin

**Together for Berlin.
Cooperations and partnerships.**

We are an active partner in the Sustainable Berlin Implementation Alliance of the Senate Department for Mobility, Transport, Climate and Environmental Protection. Together with other organizations, the administration, and committed individuals, we are preparing to scale up our projects within the network.

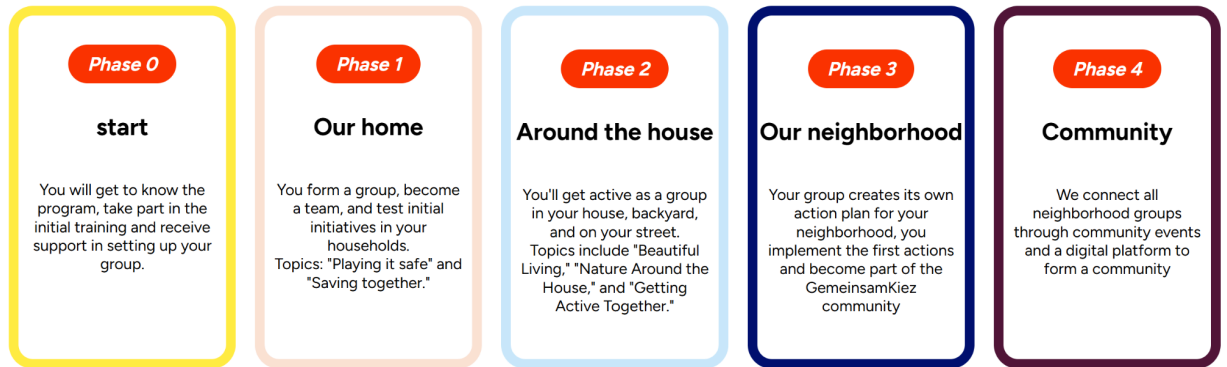
[Get in touch](#)

Solar Power to the People

- Energy transition for everyone!
- Goal: Expedite and assist individuals with implementation of residential solar power
 - Process –
 - Very simple and consumer focused approach –
 - Approached through a ‘how can we provide a direct benefit’ approach rather than ‘this is important’ and ‘trust me’
 - *“Go to your balcony, open our AI-powered app from your mobile browser, and use your mobile phone camera to create your own personalized forecast: how much electricity you’ll generate and how much money and emissions you’ll save each year.”*
 - Recognition of consumer restraints, working around needs before they arise –
 - *“Is the installation too tricky for you, you don’t have the time, or are electricians scarce and too expensive? We can find technically skilled volunteers to help you install your balcony power plant.”*
 - *“Contact us here, and we’ll match you with the right support.”*
 - Rather than creating a support system, Plan B connects individuals with those who can support already
 - This:
 - Saves overhead costs
 - Makes process even more efficient
 - Leads to simplified customer service system –
 - *“Call X business” rather than, “Oh Tim is out helping someone else, he’ll let you know”*
- Wholesale benefits from individual needs
 - Similar in concept to my “party” idea, if we deal with groups who are made of members with individual needs, registering as a group effort grants all the benefits of the “group” effort with none of the commitments/downsides
 - *When we order together, it’s cheaper for everyone. Together with our Berlin partners, we organize discounts and group orders for our community.*
- They also handle companies, which is less important for us, though interesting considering the work that might be required with local trade workers (gardeners, engineers, landscapers)

TogetherNeighborhood

- Model -



- The idea is essentially to help foster communities and neighborhoods from the ground up
 - Help a group of *already* engaged citizens who want to be more healthily communicative
 - Grow step by step
 - House
 - Surrounding ground
 - In the neighborhood, creating a plan -
 - Final healthy community
 - All steps include a *preconceived notion* of "what should our community look like"
 - The goal is to create steps that are entirely simple and easy to understand
 - The hope is that the individuals take on the work themselves after the initial push, once again reducing the overall labor required by Plan B

Implementation Alliance Berlin

- Merely a partnership with a climate organization
 - Under the motto "Berlin is our city. Together we make it better," State Secretary for the Environment Britta Behrendt launched the Sustainable Berlin Implementation Alliance on July 2, 2024. The alliance focuses on networking and raising the visibility of existing commitments.



← Meeting with locals to come up with ideas for environmental initiatives –

- Around 100 sustainability stakeholders from business, civil society, academia, politics, and administration were invited to the kick-off event at Impact Hub Berlin. On stage and in workshop groups, participants discussed the prerequisites for success for greater sustainability and developed concrete project ideas.
- State Secretary for the Environment Britta Behrendt was confident: "Those present here will succeed in developing at least 20 ideas within 30 minutes on how to advance sustainability with new cooperative solutions in the city." The ensuing lively discussion in small groups and intensive networking resulted in almost twice as many project ideas, providing important input for Berlin's sustainability strategy.

Success

- Proof of concept –
 - The whole concept moves labor around –
 - The solar initiative
 - Moves labor from the individual to contractor
 - Moves information from NGO to individual
 - Presupposes the validity of solar, and uses *already* existing motives (money) to qualify the project
 - TogetherNeighborhood
 - Moves labor from NGO to local group
 - Moves labor from local group to community
 - Eventually separates entirely – and hopefully leaves lasting change
 - Partnership with climate initiative
 - Labels the organization with the values of their partner
 - Moves labor of marketing from *their* NGO to an *already existing* NGO
 - Uses resources minimally, and serves as a meeting point

Neue Generation

Neue Generation³



- About:
 - They consider themselves *Therapists for Democracy*
- What do therapists do?



- How do you feel?
 - Assess health and stability of current Democracy
 - How did that make you feel?
 - How does democracy coexist in a larger context/environment
 - That seems like a lot of work, how do you manage it all?

- Question current systems, assess if they work, and create a plan for the future **either way**.
 - Simply support “positive” change and redirect “negative” change⁴
- What do you hope to accomplish in therapy?
 - What does an ideal democracy look like?

ALL ARE WONDERFUL RESOURCES FOR KIEZconnect -
THEY HAVE DONE THE WORK FOR US

³ <https://neuegeneration.com>

⁴ If such things can be adequately labeled

Mission Statement NG

Mission Statement –

- “Someone who knows that he can disagree also knows that he is, in a sense, agreeing when he does not disagree.”

— Hannah Arendt, Civil Disobedience⁵

This quote is on their website under the label that

- We see what happens when people around the world gather around the process of decision-making
- While this specific quote is one aspect of “decision-making” – their entire approach centers around dealing with the difficulties of people head-on
 - *We want fundamental change toward a living Earth, true democracy, a culture of humanity, and a sustainable economy. We do this by taking action, building new structures, and nonviolently opposing injustice.*
 - Clearly defined – focusing on direct action and infrastructure of equality
 - Not DEI equality, but equal access for sure
 - *Our movement is based on a clear framework that provides us with guidance and enables us to remain effective together. This framework is defined, supported, and further developed by our framework team. All those who identify with our basic philosophy and act within this framework are part of the New Generation.*
- Their framework is based on a few concepts, but it is important to understand that their mission statement *solely* focuses on the concept of a universally applied and under(stood/andable) framework
 - They have an entire team devoted to it apparently!
 - (Perhaps an opportunity for the think-tank, the possibilities are endless!)

⁵ Georg will be so excited to see this

Engagement/Democracy NG

Engagement

- How does their engagement strategy differ?
 - Well, theirs is not value-based
 - While KIEZconnect and Plan B offer support directly for *climate*, and *diversity* issues, *Neue Generation* offers a direct therapy session for national politics.
 - They believe that the system is outdated, and needs to be updated (like anything else) to continue existing healthily in a modern context
 - To do this, they define a clear framework for what engagement looks like –
 - **Vision and understanding of change**
 - *What changes we strive for—and how we intend to achieve them, from our dream of a humane society to our understanding of building and engaging.* [Learn more about our vision and our understanding of change.](#)
 - **Values & Attitude**
 - *The heart of our movement. Our values, guided by nonviolence, give us direction, shape our attitude and actions in the world, and how we interact with one another.* [Discover our values and attitude in detail.](#)
 - **Practice: Guidelines for working together**
 - *Our path to living changes today: in our interactions with one another, in sharing responsibility, and in building a new, more humane culture.* [Read our guidelines for working together.](#)
 - **Protest consensus**
 - *How we resist: Our shared framework for action and stance – nonviolent, courageous, and with heart.* [Understanding our protest consensus.](#)
- Borrowing from protestors of the past – the group is *FIERCELY NON-VIOLENT*
 - This is essential to their approach
 - While “Civil Disobedience” can be effective in the short-term
 - Eventually 500 Euro fines catch up
 - They are direct informants to the government – serving as a framework and model for Bundestag reform
 - While their goals are noble,
 - Initially approaching the highest tier of government can slow movements down

Democracy

- They directly build parliaments by citizens for citizens to ensure that everyone's voice is adequately represented
 - *We are building people's parliaments to ensure our democratic participation and bring a collective perspective into political decision-making processes.*
- Solution-based answer to solution-based problem –
 - *This creates a genuine alternative to institutions driven by profit and power interests. This can complement the current system and restore its effectiveness.*
- Work directly in line with current issues of communication
 - *We live and spread a culture of humanity based on respect, care, and community.*
- Be the space to allow people to see democracy at work, rather than tell them it does⁶.
 - *We create spaces where people can connect, heal, and act together—as an alternative to the isolation, loneliness, and competitive logic of the current system.*
- Directly countering *allegedly negative*⁷ trends in democracy
 - *We are creating the infrastructure for a new society based not on exploitation and violence, but on cooperation and justice.*
- Independent networks (also known as free labor) based in trust
 - *This includes independent networks, collective structures, and spaces where we can already put our values into practice. We run for elections and then delegate decisions to social councils.*

⁶ My English teacher heard me use 'show don't tell' from all the way back home and perked up; I am SURE

⁷ I personally think it's negative, but who am I to decide?

Projects/Success NG

Projects

- The Parliament of the People
 - *We ensure that money doesn't rule our society, but that we, the people, have a voice. That's why we come together: in the People's Parliament.*
 - *You can imagine our society as one big family and the Bundestag as the dining table where we come together and talk about what we need to make us all feel good.*
 - *It's time for us to come together and do things differently.*

By creating The Parliament of the People, Neue Generation

- Absorbs absolutely ZERO *foundational overhead* costs
- Absorbs absolutely ZERO *accountability*
- *Assumes* all risk of public liability (in bundestag tent)
- Moves the value to the people, and uses terms like “family” to cover the meaning of “free labor⁸”
- Uses “do things differently” like the corporations they seek to devalue (ironic)
- Vague idea of change - with a fitting status as a consultant
 - (according to those I know in business, they often have very little idea how the business ACTUALLY functions)

I, personally, love the idea of a therapist for the Federal Government, but it is ESSENTIAL to be *as critical as possible* if we want to learn and use their info at KIEZconnect

⁸ If you ever hear “we are like a family here” in the U.S, that means they either give ZERO benefits, overwork, underpay, or all three. In any case - RUN.

Success

- It is difficult to measure the success of an organization as vaguely oriented as this one.
 - For the sake of it –
 - They held a meeting for a few days outside the Bundestag to engage in safe discussion about ways to make federal politics more efficient and honest
 - They serve as informants – and reported to the Bundestag about their results
 - I went to the Bundestag, and saw little concrete evidence of their existence,
 - Other than, of course, *poured concrete* in construction zones

Evidence →

Fiete sent me on a quest –



Entwicklungs Stadt

Entwicklungs Stadt⁹¹⁰



- About:
 - Town hall based – intermediary/intersection between civilians and the larger political sphere
 - *We bring together politicians, administrators, civil society, and businesses in municipal development councils to jointly find answers to complex questions about the future.*
 - How do we make sure that environments are “safe”
 - *We believe that inclusive and sustainable development is most successful when all stakeholders engage in dialogue and develop common strategies.*
 - Think-tank for safe communication
 - *To support them in this task, we have developed Municipal Development Advisory Councils.*
 - *This approach is based on the research and many years of practical experience of Prof. Dr. Gesine Schwan , who first outlined the concept in Politics Despite Globalization . In close collaboration with our multidisciplinary team, the approach was further developed and put into practice.*

⁹ <https://entwicklungsstadt.de>

¹⁰ <https://www.governance-platform.org/portfolio/kommunale-entwicklungsbeiraete/>

Mission Statement ES

Mission Statement

- The entire mission of Entwicklungsbearbeitung is to create
 - *innovative and inclusive strategies for sustainable development*
- How do we do this?
 - Mentioned in: “About”
 - To support them in this task, we have developed Municipal Development Advisory Councils.
- What does the model look like?
 - Representative democracy has experienced a loss of trust. It must be supplemented by new forms of participation that involve governments, businesses, and civil society.
 - *Such a multi-stage process, the meetings by a lottery, certain citizens of an ordinary parliamentary law associates, promises a higher level of acceptance. It allows you to open sweep of conflict of interest and avoids the dangerous Illusion of a neutral state.*
 - In other words, the political scientist suggested introducing systems (with a lottery) to arrange random parliaments for local politics (like jury duty) to decide on hot-button local issues, which often require less deliberation.

Engagement/Democracy ES

Engagement

- Municipal Development Advisory Councils –
 - Involves the work of the political scientists mentioned previously in their mission statements
- They create local faux-town-halls to serve as a middle space between people and government, proving the value of civil engagement.
 - *This has been proven to work: Through collaborative work, innovative strategies emerge that are both sustainable and practical, as well as enjoying broad support within the municipality.*
 - Proof-of-concept^
- Their idea of engagement involves a few variables that the others do not
 - **Globalization –**
 - Influence of corporations
 - Interconnectedness and polarization
 - Complications added to small issues
 - **Negatives of Representative Democracy**
 - Lobbying
 - A loss of direct community voices in lieu of “efficiency”
 - This often is equally if not more inefficient
 - Potential for self-interest to override constituent interest
 - Potential for unequal representation
 - Overcomplicates little issues
 - **Layer-cake Model of Democracy**
 - Recognizes that one form of democracy does not work for all types of issues
 - Takes into consideration the weight of respective decisions
 - People are taken into account at the grassroots level

Democracy

- Their idea of democracy is closely tied to KIEZconnect's ideal vision
 - It is also value-driven
 - Emphasis on “sustainability”
 - *Infrastructure*
 - *Change*
 - *Civil models*
 - It involves randomization, which is a very new addition to other models of civil engagement
 - I am curious, however, how that might be implemented in our setting considering it may feel like a draft, which would be a very bad look.
 - *When implemented, though, it seems to reduce a lot of problems that come attached to “self-interest” principles.*
 - Overall – basic idea of democracy, and tied closely to the randomly selected person with parliamentary backing in a local setting

Projects/Success ES

Projects

- Municipality councils –

Connected to civil leaders from the start –

- *It is commissioned by local politicians to work on a specific issue affecting the municipality. Around 30 people representing local politics and administration, as well as the local economy and civil society, are selected as advisory board members*
- However – instead of being direct action based – it is *recommendation based* with a supplemental decision depending on the needs of the project
- This is dealing with much more important projects than we plan to with our initiative (city-based)



Recommendation function

Municipal development councils draw up specific recommendations for the city or municipal council. The process is continuously fed back to political bodies; however, the decision on the implementation of the results is the responsibility of the elected politicians.



Future strategies for the common good

The Municipal Development Advisory Board deals with urgent, complex and also controversial future issues facing a municipality. The strategies developed are orientated towards the common good.

Success

- **Municipality councils for recommendation papers**
 - **VERY SIMILAR TO KIEZCONNECT CURRENT STRATEGY**
 - **In 10 German municipalities, development councils made up of a wide range of stakeholders have drawn up and unanimously adopted recommendation papers.**
 - *This has been proven to work: innovative strategies that are both sustainable and practical as well as having broad support in the community are created through joint work.*

Basic restraints! →



Multi-stakeholder approach

Representatives from politics and administration, civil society and business consult together on an equal footing. They do not have an imperative mandate, but contribute the specific interests and perspectives of their stakeholder group.



Moderated dialogue

Professional process facilitation creates an open and trusting atmosphere. It thus enables genuine dialogue and the constructive negotiation of different interests.

Children's Parliament

Children's Parliament¹¹



- About:
 - Very clear 5 step process
 - Designed to work country-country
 - The entire idea is based on self-determinant democracies started by youth for the youth
 - Especially helped due to exposure at a young age to *efficient* government
 -
 -
 -

¹¹ <https://www.childrensparliament.org.uk>

Mission Statement CParli

Mission Statement

- Their goal is to empower children to actively participate in decision-making processes, advocate for their rights, duties, and collaborate with people to create inclusive and sustainable solutions for a better society
 - Youth-based
 - Fiete has mentioned the simplified ratio of people who care about democracy
 - $\frac{1}{3}$ did not care in the first place
 - $\frac{1}{3}$ are cynical
 - $\frac{1}{3}$ are optimistic and willing to contribute
 - By accessing the youth, they capture a market with a higher percentage of optimists
 - While other organizations work around existing political populations, Children's parliament makes their own market, in a market traditionally limited by national laws



Engagement/Democracy CParli

Engagement

- Children Parliament is recognized as the world's best child-led organization for child rights actions by the United Nations.
 - *“At this time in human evolution, we need to co-create a world that works for all. This will mean the inclusion of all, participative decision making, and the unleashing of the collective genius of people, especially our women and youth. This little book, with its conceptual clarity, practical examples and many tools and resources, will be a blessing for people who want to manifest a spiritually fulfilling, socially just and environmentally sustainable world for all.” –*
 - Arun Wakhlu, Author, Founder Director, Pragati Leadership Institute, Pune, India.
 - So we should get the whole world organized as neighbourhood parliaments of about 30 families each. And these parliaments thus will be where people are, and not just in State and country capitals.
 - Reinventing kleptocracy to be good-natured LOL

Democracy

- 5 Principles
 - 1. Smallness
 - Definition: *Every parliament (from neighborhood to national level) must remain a small, face-to-face community.*
 - Why?
 - Ensures every voice is heard—no one is a "nobody."
 - Prevents alienation in large, impersonal systems.
 - Result: More accountability and direct participation at all levels.
 - 2. Numerical Uniformity
 - Definition: *Every parliament at each level (neighborhood, district, state, nation) must have a fixed, limited number of members.*
 - Why?
 - Prevents population imbalances (no state/nation becomes too large).
 - Eliminates border wars (since no nation can expand beyond its fixed size).
 - Reduces military spending (no need for defense budgets, nuclear arms, etc.).
 - Result: A more peaceful, equitable world where resources go to health, education, and poverty reduction instead of war.
 - 3. Recall Scope
 - Definition: Citizens can recall (remove) representatives at any time if they underperform.
 - Why?
 - In current systems, voters are stuck with bad leaders until the next election.
 - Big elections are costly and infrequent, but in small parliaments, recalls are simple and immediate.
 - Result: True "government by the people"—power stays at the grassroots.
 - 4. Subsidiarity (Action at Lowest Levels Possible)
 - Definition: Decisions should be made at the lowest possible level (closest to the people).
 - Why?
 - Prevents unnecessary centralization of power.
 - Ensures local participation (people feel valued and consulted).
 - Result:
 - More community engagement.

- Better mental health (people feel recognized and respected).
- 5. Convergence
 - Definition: Sustain small parliaments by giving them real responsibilities (health, education, savings, marketing, etc.).
- Why?
 - Creates ownership and "we-feeling" in communities.
 - Strengthens collective identity ("Are we not here? Why wasn't this discussed with us?").
 - Result:
 - Self-sufficient communities (e.g., bulk buying, local health programs).
 - Reduces corporate control (people, not big businesses, hold economic power).

Projects/Success CParli

Projects

- Two essential questions for seminars!
 - *What would the world be like if this dream gets realized?*
 - *What good aspects would be there and what evils would not be there?*
- Essentially projects are on a voluntary basis by area
 - Each area gets in contact with the broader organization
 - Broader organization gives neighborhood coaching
 - Coaching leads to small parliaments
 - Parliaments have multi-impact benefits to the community
 - Including but not limited to
 - Therapy
 - Communication
 - Trust
 - All of the benefits we look for at KIEZconnect
 - *These experts suggest that in addition to mass media which give an extensive reach to our messages, we must also organize an adequate number of groups that would discuss, decide upon, implement and ensure the continuity of the changes proposed.*
 - Using media, they spread the message of community democracy so people could respond to the call to action themselves
 - ...Thus, they create a cycle of self-reported democratic health-*

Success



- Their country-country model is still based in NeighBureaucracy - focused on country based efforts that actually trickle down to the neighborhoods

Karin Schuster

Austria

99

Thanks for this wonderful summary. It will be a long way, but every step is worth taking. We will not be discouraged, no, we go forward, step by step! For a world where everyone really matters. Sociocracy and Neighborocracy changed my life.

Testimonials!

- By providing a system that works, people discover the benefits of democracy on their own
- *Showing* is undoubtedly better than *telling* people that democracy is important and universally beneficial

Status of Democracy

What is the Current Status of Democracy?

- According to the Neue Generation:

- *Societies repeatedly experience moments of disruption that open a window for profound change.*

So... How is it? Is it still healthy?

- Well, what does 'healthy' look like?
 - We have some preliminary and baseline ideas,
 - On-the-whole it seems that every organization has a different idea of what a healthy democracy looks like.
 - In fact, we often do not even discuss what TYPE of democracy we are referring to -
 - Participatory Democracy:
 - *Citizens directly decide on policy, and politicians implement those decisions.*
 - Pluralist Democracy:
 - *No single group dominates politics, and organized groups compete to influence policy.*
 - Elite Democracy:¹²
 - *A small, usually wealthy and educated, group influences political decisions.*
 - Parliamentary Democracy:¹³
 - *Citizens elect a legislative body (Parliament), which then selects the leader of the executive branch.*
 - Presidential Democracy:
 - *Citizens directly elect the president, who serves as both head of state and head of government.*
 - Representative Democracy:¹⁴
 - *Citizens elect representatives to make decisions on their behalf.*
 - Direct Democracy:¹⁵
 - *A form of participatory democracy where citizens directly vote on laws and policies.*
 - Liberal Democracy:
 - *A type of representative democracy emphasizing civil rights, the rule of law, and the separation of powers.*
 - Consensus Democracy:
 - *Aims for common ground and decision-making based on consensus.*

¹² Many argue that we live under one of these right now -

¹³ Used in Germany for the Bundestag (With the leader of the executive branch meaning "chancellor")

¹⁴ We use this in the U.S. and its used here too - (just not as much)

¹⁵ A local democracy would function like this

- As much as I would love to graph the healthiness of each system, it would be inefficient to write it, and it would waste the time of whoever is reading this –
 - *Instead...*
 - It would interest us to focus on the type we are addressing at the *Neighborhood* level
 - That would be, of course, *direct* democracy
 - Why?
 - Well, direct democracy functions perfectly for little projects like the ones that KIEZconnect was made for.
 - However...
 - Instead of implementing our idea of what neighborhood health looks like, we facilitate free exchange and voting for a, “*participatory democracy where citizens directly vote on laws and policies.*”

What are the pros and cons of direct democracy?



- Pros:
 - *Intellectually honest*
 - You vote *directly* for policies, not people who *may* pass the policy you want
 - *Leaves little room for the flaws of modern politics*
 - Don't get me wrong, direct democracies can involve personality politics and charisma
 - But direct democracies leave much less room for a narrative.
 - It is really hard to romanticize or demonize a wall around a park if there's no face behind it.
 - In a direct democracy - interest groups are the replacement for "parties" and "representatives"
 - *Very efficient-* (arguable)
 - Citizens immediately vote in majority to pass or reject a plan,
 - If it is rejected it is immediately thrown away,
 - If passed, a legal analyst (perhaps me) works on the legality of the proposed plan either alone or with government support (context-dependent)
 - With government approval, or legality assured, the process begins
 - *Provides a direct example of democracy working*
 - Citizens are given an immediate example of a plan they introduce being brought to the community
 - This can be compared to the modern examples of suggestion boxes that are never checked, or if they are, the public are never let in on the results.
 - *Largely participatory*
 - Those who choose to participate are *already engaged*, this is a necessary part of a growing democracy.
 - "You can lead a horse to water, you cannot make it drink"
 - Direct democracies let *already engaged* citizens serve as the model horse for other horses to learn from
 - *Educational*
 - This applies to two groups
 - Adults
 - Learn about:
 - Infrastructure, communication, and networking
 - Issues directly affecting
 - Their property values
 - Their retirement
 - Borrowing rate
 - Their community
 - Youth
 - Learn about:
 - Politics, communication, and assertiveness.
 - How to gather around an issue (which sounds good in an interview)

- Cons:
 - As Socrates so perfectly put it: “Foolish leaders of Democracy, which is a charming form of government, full of variety and disorder, and dispensing a sort of equality to equals and unequaled alike.”
 - Socrates argues through stories, as usual, “*He tells the story of a ship whose master navigator is overthrown by the crew. They do not believe that there is any skill necessary to be a navigator, and believe they are all qualified. Adeimantus concedes to Socrates that the real navigator would be called ‘an idle babbler.’*¹⁶”
 - In the words of Dan Kahan, Professor of Psychology at Yale Law School “Democracy is only as effective as the education system that surrounds it.”
 - While quotes could pile on quotes and so on, it’s essential to understand that direct democracy (in a neighborhood setting) **REQUIRES** an unbiased facilitator
 - If not unbiased, then as close to one as (X) can get.
 - In a healthy *Neighborhood* democracy, citizens would be subject to an inherently biased(as all humans are) moderator, and misled to believe that direct democracy is without any narrative
 - Further, any organization that facilitates a direct democracy is exposed to correlation with the issues citizens vote on.
 - While interests are brought forward by neighborhoods, facilitation is expedited by NGO – therefore, NGO facilitates whatever community wants
 - While it makes sense (intuitively) that if a community supports a solution, that it be carried out, an NGO is always at risk of being unfairly demonized for carrying out a widely hated idea.
 - Therefore, facilitating a direct democracy has the cons of –
 - Only being as effective as the education system within the neighborhood
 - Being foundationally flawed due to the inherent bias in any human
 - (not to mention the inherent bias in an already politically engaged human)
 - **Finally**, the inherent risk of facilitating direct democracy,
 - may unfairly label an(x) NGO with the policies of whatever neighborhood they help.

¹⁶ N. Plato *The Republic* (Line 72)

Do people believe in direct democracy, even with all of its problems?

- Reminder of my last document – ¹⁷
 - *According to the study, this is 9% higher than the average of the European countries surveyed. However, 52% of young Germans say they have no trust in the government.*
 - *When asked if they trust parliament, only 35% said "yes," 45% said "no," and 20% said "I don't know."*
 - *Young Germans have a particularly strong distrust of the media, with 60% expressing no trust in it.*
 - *Multinational corporations are also viewed critically, with 53% responding negatively to a question about their trust.*
- DEMOCRACY IS TOO BIG FOR YOUNG PEOPLE
 - *Young people (apparently) are looking for a more direct system, that relies less on the information from multinational corporations and media outlets*
- Accordingly, NGOs followed in the direction of this wave¹⁸
 - *The dissolution of the Soviet Union and the third wave of democratization in the early 1990s gave a massive boost to the proliferation of nongovernmental organizations (NGOs) in Central and Eastern Europe. These NGOs sought to tackle a range of issues: institutional development, establishing and supporting electoral processes, and working to reduce ethnic conflict, to name a few.*
 - *As such, NGOs began to be seen in the West as a precondition for democratic transition and consolidation, protecting against authoritarian overreach and holding governments accountable.*
- This directly addresses the natural state of democracy, for further proof
 - Read Thomas More's *Utopia*
 - (does not serve as direct proof, but addresses this exact issue,
 - (sparknotes done by Alistair)
 - Little island exists in a perfect utopian state, it can only be that way BECAUSE it is an isolated island
 - While the solution is NOT isolation
 - (thanks for the proof China 1368-1912)
 - It is also not as big as it is now,
 - Sometimes less is more,
 - Modern democracy is shifting towards minimalism –

¹⁷<https://www.aa.com.tr/en/europe/over-half-of-young-germans-do-not-trust-their-government-study/3129203#>

¹⁸<https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/international-organization/article/assault-on-civil-society-explaining-state-crackdown-on-ngos/71993D2DC576D810ADEC7675C229853B>

The Narrative

How do we spin a local democracy with effective marketing -

Well...

Let's stand on the shoulders of giants~

How It <i>Is</i>	How It <i>could be</i>
Thankless and frustrating	Cooperative and fulfilling!
Inefficient and difficult	A discipline development workshop!
Confrontational and inflammatory	Opportunity for trust and connection!
Upsetting and mentally-taxing	Learn negotiation strategies!
A perfect way to lose a weekend	A socially engaging event!

There are a million ways to market things that are generally unsavory or frustrating, I could go on -

- But the most important salesman tips,
 - The customer is always right (put the member first)
 - Everything is an *opportunity* not *a job*
 - Improvisation rules
 - Yes, *and...*
 - Rather than -
 - No, *but...*
 - E.g. Can we put a garden on the sidewalk -
 - *Good*
 - Yes, it is important for the neighborhood to have a garden; *and*, are we sure that the sidewalk is the most effective place for it.
 - *Bad*
 - No, we cannot put the garden there; *but*, we can put it over there.
- There is a lot to work out, as there always is, but let's be ahead of the game.

Conclusion - TBD(Designed)

Societies repeatedly experience moments of disruption that open a window for profound change.

Man is like a dog tied to a moving wagon. If the dog refuses to run along with the wagon he will be dragged by it, yet the choice remains his: to run or be dragged.

- Marcus Aurelius, *Meditations*

(Yes, I know his work is overrated; and, it fits too well to ignore.)

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